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"All the News That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, cloudy, occasional rain, high 63. **Tonight,** clearing, low 53. **Tomorrow,** warmer, sunshine giving way to afternoon clouds, shower possible, high 76. Weather map, Page A20.

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MERIDITH KOHUT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Becks in her bedroom last summer. "It's my turn to be a guinea pig," she wrote about using SR-17018, a synthetic drug, in her detox.

Going It Alone To Try to Beat An Addiction

By MATT RICHTEL

A 27-year-old woman began an experiment on herself early one morning in December 2024. Her laboratory was her childhood bedroom, tucked into a second-floor

THE NEW DRUG WAR
Do-It-Yourself Detox

corner of a pale yellow house in the Boston suburbs. On a bookshelf behind her sat a small stuffed sloth and some favorite books, including "Siddhartha" by Hermann Hesse. Her parents were asleep in the room next door.

Her name is Rebecca, but she goes by Becks. Sitting at her desk in a gray T-shirt, she opened a small plastic bag filled with white powder. The bag was stamped "SR-17018," and "NOT FOR HUMAN CONSUMPTION."

She extracted some powder with a red microscooper, poured it onto a digital scale and carefully weighed out 25 milligrams. She gathered this into a blue and white pill capsule and sealed it, and then swallowed the capsule with water. It was 4:27 a.m.

"It's my turn to be a guinea pig," Becks wrote in the online diary she was keeping of her experience. In sharing her story with The New York Times, she asked that her last name not be used so potential employers don't dis-

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War in Iran Provides China More Sway in Asia

By ALEXANDRA STEVENSON and MURPHY ZHAO

HONG KONG — As the war in Iran drags on, China has deepened its influence with fuel-starved neighbors, offering to ease shortages while pushing its renewable energy technology.

In the days after the United States and Israel attacked Iran and the Strait of Hormuz was closed, China banned oil-product exports, squeezing Asian countries that rely on its refineries for jet fuel, gasoline and diesel.

Across Asia, governments are

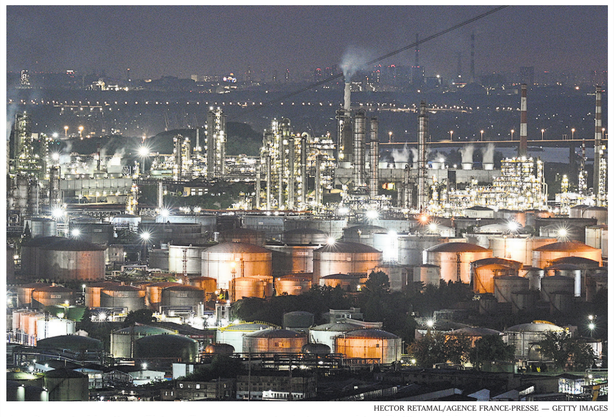
Pushing for Renewable Energy but Sending Neighbors Oil

petitioning Beijing to blunt the war's impact. Unlike the rest of the region, China is dealing from a position of strength. It is the world's largest importer of crude oil, but it has amassed huge reserves, spent decades reducing its dependence on foreign oil and poured hundreds of billions of dollars into clean energy technology.

Vietnam appealed to Beijing over its looming jet fuel shortage. The Philippines asked China not to restrict fertilizer exports. After a visit to China last month to press the subject, Australia's foreign minister said Beijing would cooperate with Australian companies on jet fuel shipments.

The outreach produced assurances from China to address regional energy security issues as well as commitments from other countries to advance diplomatic dialogue with Beijing and, in some

Continued on Page A10



HECTOR RETAMAL/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE — GETTY IMAGES

A refinery in Nanjing, China. Governments in Asia are asking Beijing to blunt the war's impact.

Virginia Ruling Rejects Democrats' House Map In Win for Republicans

National G.O.P. Edge in Gerrymandering

This article is by ***Campbell Robertson, Nick Corasaniti*** *and* ***Reid J. Epstein.***

Virginia's top court on Friday struck down a congressional map drawn by Democrats and recently approved by voters, dealing a major blow to the party as it struggles to keep pace with Republicans in the nation's redistricting battle.

The ruling will wipe out four newly drawn Democratic-leaning U.S. House districts in Virginia, giving Republicans, who have carved out more red seats across the country, a structural advantage as they enter the midterm elections.

For generations, congressional maps have been drawn once a decade, after the census, to account for population shifts. But last year, President Trump started a rare, middecade gerrymandering war when he persuaded Texas officials to draw a new map to help Republicans as they face midterm headwinds. California countered with a map favoring Democrats. Other red and blue states followed.

After Virginia voters passed the map in a statewide referendum late last month, Democrats thought that they had battled Republicans to a draw, or that they had even eked out a small advantage. Then a ruling by the U.S. Supreme Court, which further weakened the Voting Rights Act, prompted several Southern states to work to pass new maps that would favor Republicans.

Now, the rejection of the new Virginia map means that, across the country, Democrats stand to lose half a dozen safe seats, and possibly more, from redistricting alone.

Still, Republicans face a challenging political environment in their bid to retain control of their slim House majority. Mr. Trump's approval ratings have sagged as voters worry about the economy, the war with Iran and high gas prices.

In its 4-to-3 opinion, the Virginia Supreme Court wrote that Democratic legislators had violated the state's Constitution with their move to enact a new map meant to give their party 10 out of the state's 11 U.S. House seats, up from the six it currently controls. Virginia voters had approved a constitutional amendment to allow for the map in a referendum.

The problem, the court's majority suggested, was that the first vote on the amendment in the General Assembly, which would authorize Democrats to redraw the map, occurred days before last fall's legislative elections — meaning that some Virginians who cast their ballots early did so without knowing how their state lawmakers would vote on the new map.

That, the justices wrote, violated the process laid out in the State Constitution.

Continued on Page A15

TENNESSEE A lawsuit says a district map is illegal because it was approved too late. PAGE A15

2 Thieves, 29 Church Targets And a Lot of Angst for France

By CATHERINE PORTER and ANA CASTELAIN

BURELLES, France — The villagers of Burelles transformed their church into a fortress several centuries ago, securing it with a defensive wall, a safe room and arrow slits to protect them from marauding troops.

All those defenses did nothing to stop a pair of thieves who ransacked the Roman Catholic church at some point before 7 p.m. one Sunday in late July.

They smashed the donation box, broke through the wooden sacristy door and grabbed communion plates, two vials used at baptisms and an ornate brass frame known as a monstrance, which is used to display bread during communion services.

That same day, the same thieves stole a chalice from the church in Vervins, the next village up the road in northern France. The next day, they struck the church in another nearby village, Marle, breaking open its tabernacle and stealing another elaborate chalice.

These were just three of the 29 churches across northern France that, a court ruled, were targeted last summer by Raphaël Hour-

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ANDREA MANTOVANI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

The tabernacle at the church of St. Martin in Burelles.

ABC Accuses F.C.C. of Impinging on Free Speech

By JIM RUTENBERG and JOHN KOBLIN

ABC has accused the Federal Communications Commission of violating its free speech rights, potentially setting the stage for a protracted, high-stakes legal battle between the network and the Trump administration.

The company said in a filing with the agency that regulators had a "chilling effect" on free

Fighting Administration Over 'The View'

speech by trying to punish political content they disagreed with. The filing, made public on Friday, is the most aggressive defense from any television network since President Trump kicked off an extended campaign last year to bring media organizations to heel.

It represented a striking departure for ABC. The network, under the corporate stewardship of the Walt Disney Company, set an early tone of compliance toward Mr. Trump when it settled a defamation lawsuit with him for $15 million in December 2024. Many legal experts considered Mr. Trump's case unlikely to succeed in court.

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Adding Debt and Losing Sleep to See World Cup

This article is by ***Tariq Panja, Emma Bubola*** *and* ***Lucía Cholakian Herrera.***

BUENOS AIRES — Matias Celestino rattles off in order all 18 qualification games the Argentina men's national soccer team played en route to this year's World Cup. He attended all of them, nine at home and nine away, traversing the continent with his drum to cheer on his nation, the

High Ticket Prices Test Avid Argentine Fans

defending world champions.

Now, Mr. Celestino, 43, is preparing for the crowning moment of that marathon effort: taking his drum, but also his wife and son, to Argentina's World Cup matches in the United States this summer.

It's the worst time to be a passionate Argentina fan.

Argentine supporters, for whom soccer can be an obsession, have always flocked to World Cups by the tens of thousands, providing a visual and sonic backdrop at recent tournaments in Brazil, Russia and Qatar. Now they find themselves facing the highest-ever ticket prices for this summer's World Cup in the United

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INTERNATIONAL A4-12
Boat Attacks by the U.S.
The Times has been tracking the military's strikes on boats in the Caribbean and Pacific. As of this week, there have been 56, with 190 men killed. PAGE A6

NATIONAL A13-21
Rent Freeze Clears Hurdle
Mayor Zohran Mamdani's push to freeze rents for nearly one million New York apartments cleared a major hurdle with the Rent Guidelines Board. PAGE A21

BUSINESS B1-6
War Threatens 'City of Glass'
In India, Firozabad has depended on glassmaking for centuries. Fuel prices are starting to weigh on businesses already under pressure. PAGE B1

ARTS C1-6
America at the Venice Biennale
In the U.S. Pavilion, where works are expected to "reflect and promote American values," Alma Allen's sculptures are unlikely to offend. PAGE C1

OPINION A22-23
Jessica Grose PAGE A23

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